

Instagram Community & Membership Strategy

What the visible @mindmichael audience responds to, what it expects, and how to invite it into a living sangha without pressure.

Prepared from	The public Instagram profile, a six-post recent sample, one historical course announcement, client records, and existing Vajragarbha strategy.
Research date	20 August 2026 · Europe/Lisbon
Important	Public comments are candidate evidence only. Publication requires permission and relationship verification.

Executive summary

Michael Gregory's verified Instagram account, @mindmichael, showed approximately **36.8K followers** and **5,714 following** on 20 August 2026. The account is substantially larger than the visible Facebook profile and posts at a high cadence.

The recent feed is teaching-led: quotations, short contemplations, advanced Dzogchen material, lineage imagery and practical reflections. In a six-post sample from 12-19 August, posts averaged **210 likes** and **5.3 comments**. The strongest sampled post was a concise teaching on luminous awareness, with 286 likes and 11 comments.

Primary recommendation

“Use Instagram to create recognition and a felt encounter with the teaching. Move interested people to one clearly matched next step: a free course, a live class, or a membership explanation - never directly from every post to checkout.”

Strategic conclusion

Immediate priorities

- Clarify the profile link path: beginner, practitioner, current student.
- Create more original short video encounters with Lama Michael, while preserving quotation posts that already earn attention.
- Use Stories and pinned posts to explain the weekly sangha rhythm, recordings, time zones and prerequisites.
- Seek permission for any comment used as social proof; the current sample contains appreciation and inquiry, not verified student outcomes.
- Add tagged links so Instagram contribution can be measured without confusing reach with membership readiness.

Evidence, scope and limitations

This report uses the public @mindmichael profile as rendered without an Instagram login, six recent posts, an indexed 2022 Dzogchen transmission announcement, the project's Facebook analysis, and the canonical Vajragarbha client reference.

What the visible data can establish

- Follower and following counts shown on the profile.
- Displayed likes and comments on sampled public posts.
- Visible captions, posting dates, comment language and recurring themes.
- The profile bio, verification status and visible link destination.

What it cannot establish

- Reach, impressions, saves, shares, profile visits or follower demographics.
- Story completion, Reel watch time, link clicks or attributed purchases.
- Whether a commenter is a student, customer, retreat participant or casual follower.
- Why Instagram shows or withholds individual posts and comments to logged-out visitors.

Obtain an Instagram Insights export before making channel-budget decisions. Public counts are directional evidence, not a substitute for account analytics.

Visible Instagram statistics

Measure	Visible figure	Interpretation
Account	@mindmichael · verified	Personal teacher-led identity
Followers	Approx. 36.8K	Meaningful international reach
Following	5,714	High reciprocal/network orientation
Recent sample	6 posts · 12-19 Aug 2026	Teaching-led snapshot
Average likes	210	Stable acknowledgement on text/image posts
Average comments	5.3	Conversation exists but is lighter than appreciation
Profile link	Free 6-week mindfulness course + other links	Good beginner path; needs clearer segmentation

Six-post sample

Date/theme	Likes	Comments
19 Aug · thoughts as bubbles	188	4
18 Aug · letting go / rigpa	155	2
16 Aug · non-attachment	115	3
15 Aug · luminous awareness	286	11
14 Aug · bare awareness	267	5
12 Aug · practice and everyday life	247	7

The sample is too small for performance forecasting. Its value is qualitative: practical, concise teachings and direct statements invite the most visible discussion.

What the recent feed is doing

Teaching and contemplation

Most posts deliver a complete thought from a respected teacher. This creates trust and save-worthy value without requiring a click.

Lineage and advanced language

Rigpa, bare awareness, Longchenpa and practice distinctions signal seriousness. This is an asset for practitioners, but newcomers need occasional plain-language bridges.

Visual rhythm

The grid is dominated by images with text, teachers, sacred places and quotations. It feels like a contemplative library more than a personality-led creator feed.

Human presence

The bio presents a banker-to-Buddhist-monk story and personal life. More short, appropriately filmed clips of Lama Michael would connect this human promise to the actual feed.

Promotion

A 7 August 2022 Dzogchen Tantras Transmission post gave date, schedule, Zoom/recording access, teacher biography, dharma rationale and scholarship language. It drew 255 likes but only one visible comment. Information was thorough; the invitation arrived as an announcement rather than a staged relationship sequence.

Comment library: useful signals, not yet testimonials

The sampled comments are strongest as evidence of resonance, comprehension and questions. None of the recent comments proves course participation or an outcome. Use only with permission and describe them accurately.

Candidate: appreciation

“Thank you, Michael for sharing this wonderful - deep quotation!”

Instagram commenter · luminous-awareness post · 15 Aug 2026

Candidate: reflection

“Short moments, many times ... allow awareness to find clarity.”

Instagram commenter · luminous-awareness post · 15 Aug 2026

Candidate: practical engagement

“Practice removing the lens...”

Instagram commenter · luminous-awareness post · 15 Aug 2026

Candidate: teaching question

“If I'm not mistaken one doesn't need to be in a meditative posture to experience raw awareness. Correct?”

Instagram commenter · bare-awareness post · 14 Aug 2026

Editorial assessment of the comments

What they demonstrate

- The audience does more than react: some people restate the teaching in their own words.
- Specific practice language receives thoughtful questions.
- Gratitude is frequent, including repeated thanks from recurring accounts.
- Many comments are emojis, which indicate warmth but are weak website proof.

What they do not demonstrate

- Enrollment, attendance or membership status.
- A change attributable to Lama Michael's teaching.
- A sustained student-teacher relationship.
- Permission to reuse the person's words or username.

Recommendation

Do not build the website testimonial section from the sampled Instagram comments alone. First invite known students to describe one concrete experience: the teaching attended, how long they have practiced, what the weekly rhythm helps them do, and what they would tell a newcomer. Instagram comments can then support those stronger accounts as short, permissioned signals.

What this community appears to expect

Substance in the post itself

The audience is accustomed to receiving a complete teaching without leaving Instagram. A caption that withholds the value to force a click will weaken trust.

Precision without simplification

Advanced terms are welcome, but concise context helps newer followers understand whether a post is for them.

Continuity

High posting frequency and recurring teachers create a daily-study expectation. Membership should be presented as a deeper rhythm, not as access to basic inspiration that was previously free.

International access

The historical announcement emphasized Zoom and recordings. Time zones, replay access and start dates should appear early in every invitation.

Lineage integrity

The audience responds to named teachers and specific teachings. Prerequisites, transmission requirements and attribution must remain explicit.

Warmth and dialogue

Questions show a desire for clarification. Answering a small number of substantive comments in Lama Michael's or the organisation's voice could turn broadcasting into relationship.

How to position the membership

Instagram already provides abundant free teachings. Therefore the membership cannot honestly be sold as “more content”. Its value is structure, relationship, practice and belonging.

“A living rhythm of practice, teaching and spiritual friendship - with a clear next step in a path taught in order.”

Recommended positioning

The promise

- You do not have to assemble a path alone.
- Live teaching and guided practice make understanding participatory.
- A weekly rhythm helps practice continue beyond moments of inspiration.
- Recordings and time-zone clarity make a global sangha usable.
- Prerequisites protect the student and the lineage.
- Free teaching remains available whether or not someone joins.

Do not promise

- Transformation, healing, awakening or attainment on a timetable.
- Unlimited personal access to Lama Michael.
- Transmission or empowerment through payment or recorded viewing.
- Scarcity, urgency or guaranteed outcomes.

Instagram-specific conversion path

Stage	Instagram job	Next step
Discovery	Reels, quotations and shared teachings earn attention	Follow or save
Recognition	Repeated themes and Lama Michael's voice establish fit	Visit profile
Orientation	Pinned posts and Highlights explain teacher, path and schedule	Choose beginner/practitioner/current student path
Experience	Invite to free course or one relevant live class	Attend and receive email
Relationship	Email and live teaching answer practical questions	Continue practice
Membership	Show weekly rhythm and community after experience	Join the Sangha

Core rule

One post should not attempt the whole journey. A contemplative quotation may invite a save. A short teaching clip may invite a profile visit. A course post may invite registration. Membership is most appropriate after recognition and experience.

Profile, pinned posts and Highlights

Bio

Keep the human story, but name the teaching destination clearly: Lama Michael Gregory · Vajragarbha · Buddhist & Dzogchen teachings. Avoid making the retreat/hotel identity compete with the teaching path.

Recommended three pinned posts

- Start here: who Lama Michael is, who the teaching serves, and the free course.
- The path: a simple 01-05 explanation of foundations through advanced Dzogchen.
- The living sangha: weekly rhythm, recordings, time zones, suitability and how to learn more.

Recommended Highlights

Highlight	Purpose
Start Here	Orientation for new visitors
Free Course	Explain the complete six-week offering
Live This Week	Current schedule with time zones
The Path	Foundations, stages and prerequisites
Sangha	What members actually do together
Retreats	Pemako, suitability and preparation
Teacher	Story, lineage and teaching style
Questions	Recordings, access, price support and contact

Content strategy for Instagram

Pillar	Role	Example
One teaching	Earn attention and saves	A complete 20-40 second teaching clip
Practice bridge	Turn inspiration into action	One small practice for the next day
Teacher in the room	Build familiarity and trust	Contextualized short video with approved framing
The path	Reduce catalogue confusion	One stage, who it serves, what comes next
Weekly rhythm	Make membership tangible	Tuesday teaching or Sacred Sunday invitation
Student voice	Show belonging carefully	Permissioned, specific student account
Retreat and land	Communicate depth and place	Preparation, environment or milestone
Practical clarity	Remove access uncertainty	Time zones, recordings, prerequisites

Recommended balance

Preserve the high-value quotation stream, but gradually make 30-40% of weekly output original or contextualized: Lama Michael speaking, a short practice bridge, a path explainer, or a clear community invitation. This converts borrowed authority into a relationship with the actual teacher and sangha.

A calm weekly publishing rhythm

Day	Format	Purpose
Monday	Carousel or still: one complete teaching	Serve and earn saves
Tuesday	Story: live teaching today + time zones	Operational clarity
Wednesday	Short video: Lama Michael or practice bridge	Human connection
Thursday	Question box or comment response	Listen and clarify
Friday	Path or course explainer	Orientation
Sunday	Sacred Sunday / sangha glimpse	Belonging
Launch period	A themed sequence over several weeks	Teach first; invite near the real opening

Caption structure

- Give the teaching or insight first.
- Add one sentence of context: who it is for or how to practice with it.
- State access facts plainly: date, time zone, recordings, prerequisites and price support if confirmed.
- Use one invitation only.
- Avoid dense blocks of logistics; link to a calm, complete page.

How to communicate with this community

Voice

- Plain, warm and unhurried.
- Specific about what happens and when.
- Confident enough to preserve advanced language, generous enough to gloss it.
- Invitation rather than command; no countdown theatre or spiritual FOMO.
- Lama Michael as experienced practitioner and guide, never through guru inflation.

Conversation practice

- Reply selectively to real practice questions, not every emoji.
- Turn recurring questions into a monthly Q&A; Reel or carousel.
- Thank people for thoughtful restatements without validating attainment claims.
- Move personal suitability, crisis or transmission questions to an appropriate private/human channel.
- Never give medical or mental-health treatment advice in comments.

Information standard

- Exact dates and times with a converter link.
- Whether recordings are included and for how long.
- Prerequisites and intended level near the top.
- Dharma, sliding scale or scholarship only when confirmed.
- A useful free option on every paid invitation.

Measurement and learning plan

Public engagement is a signal of resonance, not proof of business or spiritual value. Instagram Insights should be exported before deciding which formats deserve more effort.

Baseline metrics to obtain

- Follower growth and follower geography/time zones.
- Reach by followers vs non-followers and by content format.
- Saves, shares, comments, profile visits and follows per post.
- Reel watch time, completion and replays.
- Story completion, exits, replies and link taps.
- Profile-link clicks by destination.

Recommended events

Use tagged links for free-course signup, live-class registration, membership information and completed checkout. Keep source, content theme and campaign visible in reporting.

Decision rules

- High saves/shares but low clicks: the teaching resonates; the next step may be unclear.
- High profile visits but low link taps: simplify the bio and destination choices.
- High course registration but low attendance: improve reminders and time-zone clarity.
- High attendance but low membership interest: explain the weekly rhythm and suitability.
- Membership clicks but failed checkout: inspect price clarity, support options and technical flow.

30 / 60 / 90-day action plan

Period	Actions
First 30 days	Export Insights. Confirm bio ownership and destinations. Audit the previous 90 days by format and theme. Create three pinned-post outlines and eight Highlights. Request permission from known students for specific testimonials.
Days 31-60	Publish the balanced weekly pattern. Test two approved Lama Michael video formats. Add tagged links. Build a single membership information page focused on rhythm, suitability, recordings, schedule and free alternatives.
Days 61-90	Compare saves, qualified comments, profile visits, free-course signups and live attendance. Interview a small number of students. Refine membership messaging from their words without making outcome claims.

“Invite a small number of known students to describe, in their own words, what changes when teaching becomes a weekly relationship rather than a collection of recordings.”

Most useful next move

Timeline and identifiable activity

Date	Event	What it shows
7 Aug 2022	Dzogchen Tantras Transmission announcement	Detailed Zoom, recordings, schedule, dharma, scholarship and teacher context; 255 likes, one visible comment.
11 Oct 2024	Indexed Reel: gentle childlike wonder	Short contemplative video language enters the discoverable footprint.
16 May 2025	Indexed "Peace Be With You" post	Personal blessing and universal aspiration.
Late 2025	Opening the Heart retreat content	Retreat promotion connects emotional themes, Lama Michael and Quiet Mind.
Mar 2026	Vajra and Bell teaching post	Traditional symbolism; Google displayed 720+ likes.
12-19 Aug 2026	Six-post teaching sample	115-286 likes and 2-11 comments; high posting cadence and teaching-first usage.
20 Aug 2026	Profile snapshot	Verified; approx. 36.8K followers; link includes free six-week course.

Dates and public counts are snapshots. Google-indexed figures may reflect a different capture time than Instagram's current display.

Appendix: testimonial permission request

Suggested direct message or email

“Hello [Name], Thank you for the thoughtful comment you shared on Lama Michael’s Instagram post. We are gently updating the Vajragarbha website and would be grateful for permission to include your words in a small “What students say” section. Your original comment was: “[COMMENT]” Would you be comfortable with us publishing this, either exactly as written or in a shorter version that we send to you for approval first? If so, could you also tell us whether you have studied or practiced with Lama Michael, which teaching or course you joined, and how you would like your name to appear? There is no pressure at all. We will only publish it with your clear permission. Warmly, Vajragarbha”

Use only after confirming the account and the person's relationship to the teachings.

Source references

- Instagram: [instagram.com/mindmichael/](https://www.instagram.com/mindmichael/)
- Recent public posts: 12-19 August 2026 sample listed in this report.
- Historical post: [instagram.com/mindmichael/p/Cg-z23zL2CD/](https://www.instagram.com/mindmichael/p/Cg-z23zL2CD/)
- Google-indexed public Instagram results used only where noted.
- Client reference folder: /Users/christophekaisin/Documents/Davita - Michael /
- Project AGENTS.md and current Vajragarbha strategy.

Prepared as an internal strategy document. Verify changing dates, prices, schedules, access rules and permissions before publication.